

Class 3: Taking Medicines

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Diabetes Education



In this class you will learn:

- Tips on taking your medicines the right way
- Where and how your diabetes medicines work to control your blood sugars
- When insulin is needed in order to control your blood sugars
- Ways to help you remember to take your medicines
- How to refill a prescription at the pharmacy



What medicines do you take for your diabetes?

What makes it hard to take your diabetes medicines?



- Susie is 35 years old, she has 2 kids, and works at a grocery store
- She has diabetes, but has been able to control it with diet, exercise, and metformin
- Over the last few months, work has been hectic
- Susie has had a hard time balancing work, family, and a healthy lifestyle
- She is visiting her provider today to talk about her blood work and is very nervous





- Her hemoglobin A1c has gotten worse, and the provider thinks it is time to start a second medicine
- Susie is not happy about this, but is willing to hear what her options are:



Tablets

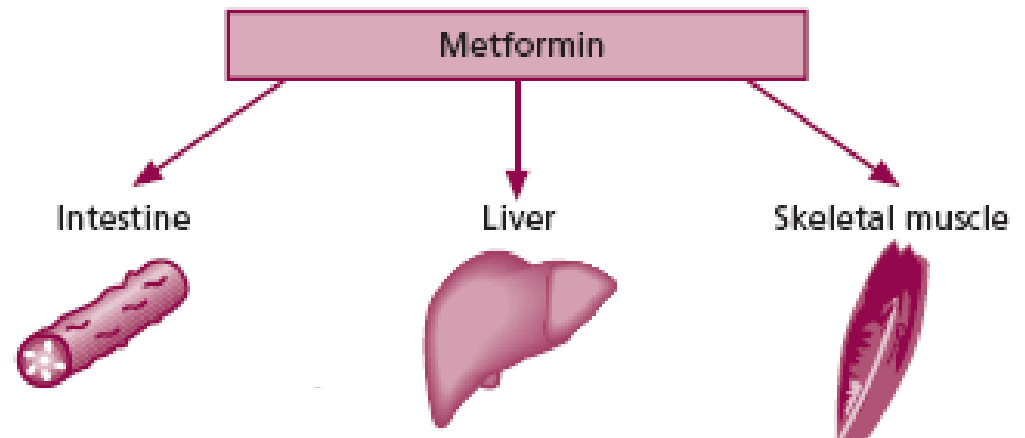
Insulins

**Non-Insulin
Injectables**

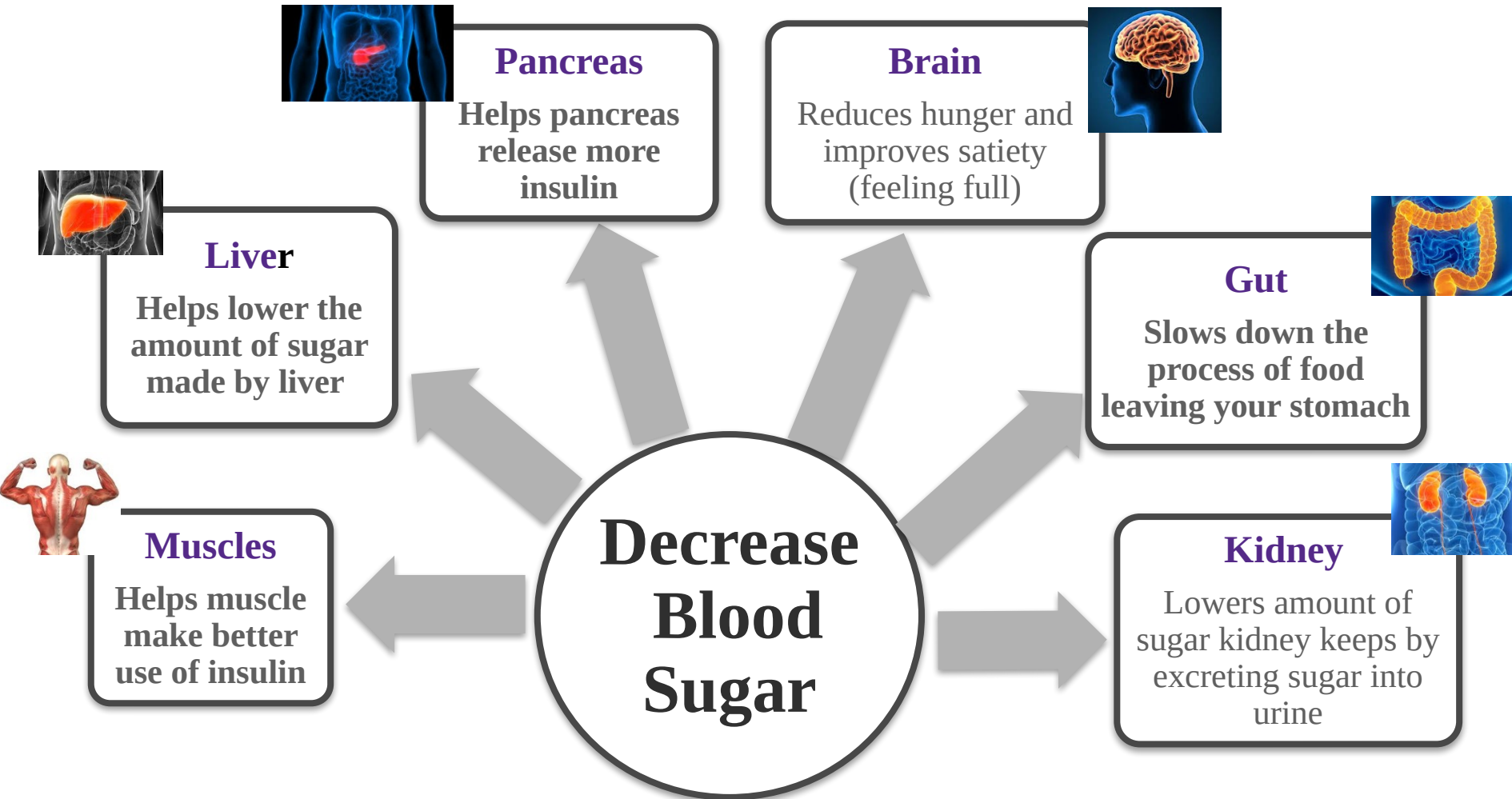
Susie is worried about taking a second medicine because she already has diarrhea with metformin!

– **Metformin** (Glucophage)

- Take with food
- **Common side effects**
 - Upset stomach
 - Diarrhea



Diabetes medicines work in different parts of your body





Medicines	Where they work
Glipizide Glimepiride Glyburide	Pancreas
Metformin (Glucophage®)	Liver, muscle
Pioglitazone (Actos®)	Muscle, liver
Sitagliptin (Januvia®) Saxagliptin (Onglyza®) Linagliptin (Tradjenta®) Alogliptin (Nesina®)	Pancreas, liver
Empagliflozin (Jardiance®) Canagliflozin (Invokana®) Dapagliflozin (Farxiga®)	Kidney
Liraglutide (Victoza®) Exenatide (Byetta®/Bydureon®) Lixiasenatide (Lyxumia®) Dulaglutide (Trulicity®) Semaglutide (Ozempic®)	Pancreas, brain, gut, liver



- **What if my blood sugar gets too low on more medicines?**
 - This used to happen to my grandmother all the time and she felt so sick. Cookies helped though!
 - **Not all medicines** cause low blood sugars, but some do:
 - **Glipizide, glimepiride, pioglitazone, insulin**
- **What is a low blood sugar level?**
- **How do you feel when you have a low blood sugar?**
- **What are you supposed to take to treat it?**
- **What can you do to avoid low blood sugar from your medicines?**



Hypoglycemia

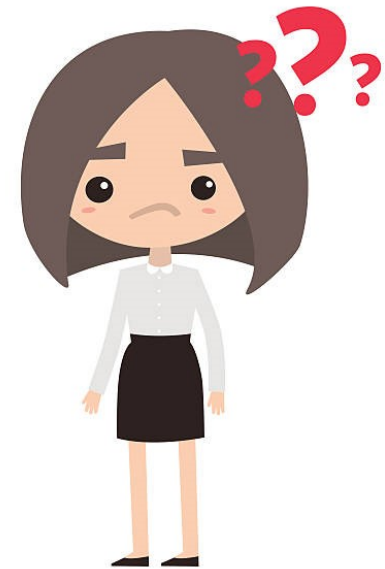
Low blood
sugar

Less than 70
mg/dL

What symptoms might you feel if you are having a low blood sugar?

- **Susie still has some questions:**

- What happens if I stop taking the medicine?
- Will I be on this medicine forever?
- Will this cure my diabetes?





- Medicines are **not a cure** for diabetes
- Medicine does not take the place of healthy eating and exercise
- You may need more than one medicine to treat diabetes
- Checking your blood sugar is the only way to know if you are on enough medicines to control your diabetes



Susie visits with her doctor 3 months later and her blood sugars are still high. The doctor recommends an injectable medicine.

- WAIT! Now you are saying I may have to inject myself!
- I don't like needles! They hurt!





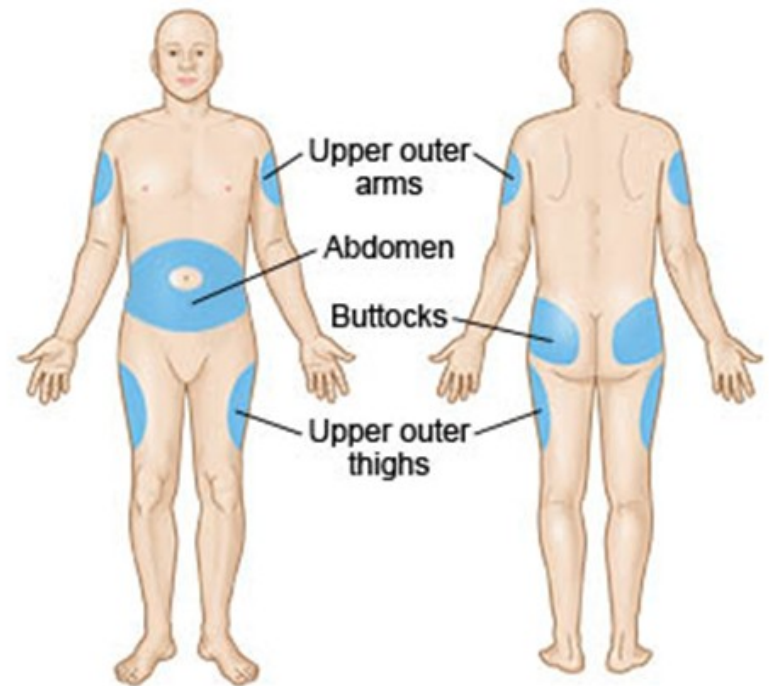
- **GLP 1 RA Medicines**
 - Liraglutide (Victoza®)
 - Exenatide (Byetta®/Bydureon®)
 - Lixasenatide (Lyxumia ®)
 - Dulaglutide (Trulicity®)
 - Semaglutide (Ozempic®)
- **Lowers blood sugar levels by the way they work on the pancreas, gut, liver, and the brain**
- **May be taken either daily and/or weekly**
- **May be used with insulin and/or other oral medicines**
- **May cause weight loss**



- **Insulin shots will hurt**
- **Insulin will make your diabetes worse**
- **Insulin will hurt your eyes**
- **Starting insulin means you have failed**
- **People who take insulin have the “bad” type of diabetes**
- **Insulin is your last chance**



- **There are different types of insulin**
 - Discuss with your provider to see what fits your routine the best
- **Belly (or abdomen) is best!**
- **Do not give a shot into scars or a place with infection**
- **Use a different place for each shot.**
- **Do not rub the place after the shot.**



Use the places below



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Insulin and injectable storage



Keep in the fridge



Keep it away from
the sun and heat.



Precipitated

Lumpy

Frosted

Check for crystals (flakes)
or lumps.

Make sure your medicine has not expired.

If your medicine is not stored right, it will go bad quickly!



Where do you keep your medicines?



Keep in a **cool** and **dry** place
Keep away from children



**“I’m already on blood pressure medicine and metformin!
How am I going to keep track of all my medicines!
This is a lot!”**

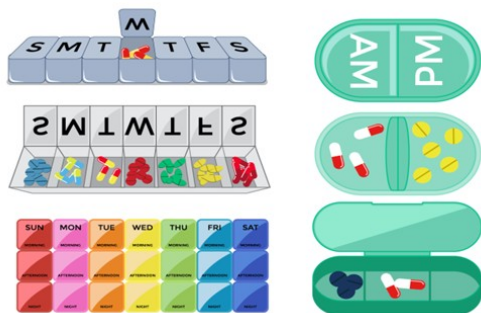




- **Know your medicine**
 - Name
 - Dose
 - When to take your it
- **The shape and color of pills may change**
- **Keep a medicine list**



- Pill box



- Alarm



- Medicine List



- Cell Phone Apps or Alarm





- **If you forget to take your medicines:**
 - **Once a day medicines:**
 - If you forget to take your daily morning dose, but remember later that day, go ahead and take one dose of the medicine.
 - **Two or more times a day medicines:**
 - If you forget to take the first dose, skip it, and take the second dose.
 - Then go back to your regular schedule

Never take two doses of your medicine at the same time!



**Susie would like to get her medicines refilled at Parkland.
What does she need to do?**

Options include:

- Phone
- MyChart
- Dropbox Form

<https://www.parklandhospital.com/getting-your-medicine>

**What if Susie does not have any refills left?
How is she going to get her medicines?**



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How to refill your medicines

ZZPHARMNET, HENRY TEST **MRN Z147258369**

LISINOPRIL 40 MG TAB
Take 1 tablet by mouth one time a day

Qty: 30 **03/25/2015**
5 Refills Expire 02/01/16 brpate / BP /
NDC 68180-0517-03 **LUPIN PHARMACEUTICALS**
Discard by 03/25/2016 unless directed to discard earlier
Smith, D **Proxy:**
RX# 014173817 **P3** **Phone #: (214)590-2859**
Parkland Central Pharmacy 5201 Harry Hines Blvd. Dallas, TX 75235

CAUTION: Federal law prohibits transfer of this medicine to any person other than the patient for whom prescribed. Do not use for business. Do not operate a vehicle, drink alcohol, or perform other dangerous tasks until you know how this medicine affects you.

WARNING: Do Not Use If You Are Pregnant, Suspect That You Are Pregnant, Or While Breastfeeding. Check With Your Doctor Or Pharmacist.

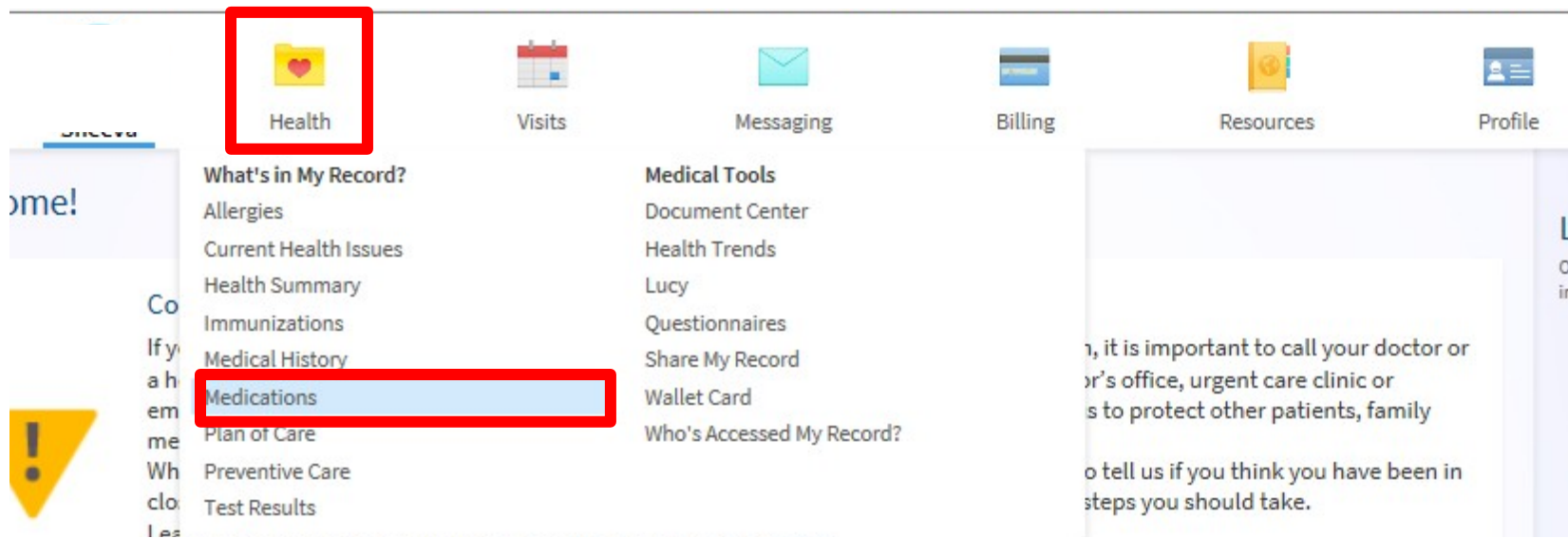
Do Not Use A Salt Substitute Without Checking With Your Doctor Or Pharmacist



- If your bottle says “no refills”, this **does not** mean you can stop taking the medicine.
- Call earlier to request refill if “no refills” remain on prescription.
- You do not need to request a new prescription from your doctor if you already have refills on your prescription. **Just call pharmacy to refill your medicine.**
- If you get your medicines filled outside of Parkland, **follow that pharmacy’s process.**



- Select Health tab, then Medications to see your medicine list





Health



Visits



Messaging



Billing



Resources



Profile

Medications



Please review your medications and verify that the list is up to date. **Call 911 if you have an emergency.**

REQUEST REFILLS

metFORMIN 500 mg tablet

Commonly known as: GLUCOPHAGE

[Learn more](#)

Take 2 tablets by mouth twice a day with meals

2 refills before July 27, 2021

Prescription Details

Prescribed July 27, 2020

Approved by [Manisha Raja, MD](#)

Prescription number 0762287002

Refill Details

Quantity 360 tablets

Next fill July 27, 2020

Pharmacy Details

PMH ANDERSON CLINIC AND DISCHARGE PHARMACY

5184 Tex Oak Ave, Dallas TX 75235

214-590-6120



Request Refill



Remove



Check your discharge paperwork (AVS) for instructions

- New medicine started
- Dosage change
- Medicine stopped
- Future appointments, medicine list, education

Example of medicine change on medicine list:



insulin glargine 100 unit/mL inj soln

También conocido como: LANTUS

Modificado por: [REDACTED]

Inject 50 units under the skin once daily at bedtime

Lo que cambió:

- dosis a tomar
- cómo lo debe tomar
- cuándo lo debe tomar
- instrucciones adicionales



insulin regular 100 unit/mL inj soln

También conocido como: NovoLIN

Modificado por: [REDACTED]

Inject 10 units under the skin before breakfast, 15 units before lunch, and 15 units before supper

Lo que cambió: instrucciones adicionales

Questions?



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